

16. Source: First meeting with the Tribal Leaders

Upon their arrival, the Health for All (HfA) delegation was met by the leader of the Beta Town tribal council. The meeting commenced on a somber note as the tribal chief voiced his displeasure about the delegation's unsanctioned visit to the residence. Emphasizing the importance of maintaining respect for the council's authority, he conveyed his perception that HfA's actions were complicating matters further.

Making his expectations clear, the tribal leader stressed that all discussions pertaining to the situation should be restricted to the confines of the council's office. He communicated his concerns about the safety of the delegation, highlighting the potential risks associated with informal visits and discussions outside of the designated space. He firmly advised the delegation against any attempts to communicate with the detained international staff until an amicable resolution to the ongoing issues is reached.

Meanwhile, the tribal leader expressed the view that HfA needs to show a proper will to find a solution to this growing crisis. The HfA activities at the hospital need to restart promptly as HfA takes the engagement to continue its operations in Beta Town. The families of local guards need to be compensated for their loss. Finally, HfA needs to take the necessary measure to re-enforce the capacity of local health authorities to respond to the measles outbreak. Once the HfA delegation has made clear commitment on these urgent issues, it will be able to visit its colleagues and resume their operations at the hospital.

Concluding the meeting without giving an opportunity to the delegation to react, the tribal chief excused himself, leaving the delegation with instructions to await further guidance while stationed at their hotel. tribespeople accompany the delegation to the car and escort them to the hotel.